Pink Youth Competition Group 5 project

PINK YOUTH COMPETITION PROJECT PROPOSAL

PROJECT TITLE

PINK BOOK



“A Book That Speaks Beyond Words”

Theme: Breast Health Education, Early Action & Inclusive Community Access
Target Area: Rwanda
Target Beneficiaries: Women, men, families, youth, and communities, especially people with limited access to phones, internet, literacy, and health information.

1. PROJECT INTRODUCTION

Breast cancer is not only a health issue; it is also an information and access issue.

Health information can be shared through social media, websites, television, smartphones, and printed materials. However, not everyone in Rwanda has access to these resources. Some people live in communities with limited access to technology. Some do not own phones or smartphones, while others may have difficulty reading complicated written health information.

The Pink Book is proposed as an inclusive breast-health education project designed to make important information understandable and accessible to people regardless of their literacy level, access to technology, or location.

The project will create a simple, attractive, picture-based educational book containing carefully prepared breast-health information in different languages according to language people use, supported by illustrations, simple explanations, questions, stories, and practical guidance.

The book will not replace doctors, nurses, screening services, diagnosis, or treatment. Instead, it will serve as an education and communication tool that helps people understand breast health, recognize concerning changes, challenge myths, and know when to seek professional medical advice.

Our vision is simple:

> **“No Rwandan should be left behind because they cannot read, afford a smartphone, have the internet, or live far from digital information.”**

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2. THE PROBLEM WE WANT TO SOLVE

Our project begins with one important question:

> **If our breast-health campaign reaches only people who have smartphones, internet, education, and the ability to read, have we really reached everyone?**

There are several barriers that can prevent health information from reaching people.

2.1 Literacy barrier

Some people may struggle to understand long medical explanations.

A poster containing many words may not communicate its message effectively to everyone.

2.2 Technology barrier

A person may not have:

- **A smartphone**
- **Internet access**
- **WhatsApp**
- **Social media**
- **A computer**

Therefore, a digital-only campaign cannot reach everyone.

2.3 Language barrier

Medical information can sometimes be difficult to understand when it uses complicated terminology.

People need information communicated in simple, familiar language.

2.4 Distance and access barrier

Some communities may have less direct access to educational resources and health information.

Therefore, information should not only wait for people to search for it.

It should travel to the community.

2.5 Fear and misinformation

People can receive health information from friends, social media, rumors, or traditional beliefs.

Some may also feel afraid to discuss breast health.

A good educational tool should create a safe way to begin conversations.

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3. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

What is the Pink Book?

The Pink Book is a specially designed breast-health education book that uses:

🖼️ **Pictures**
🗣️ **Simple Kinyarwanda**
📖 **Short explanations**
❓ **Questions**
💬 **Stories and conversations**
❌ **Myth vs. fact activities**
🏥 **Guidance on seeking professional health advice**

The book is designed so that a person does not need advanced reading ability to understand its main messages.

For example:

🖼️ Picture

A woman notices an unusual breast change.

🗣️ Simple message

“Nubona impinduka idasanzwe, ntukayirengagize. Ganira n’umukozi w’ubuzima ubifitiye ubumenyi.”

❓ Question

“Wakora iki uramutse ubonye impinduka idasanzwe?”

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4. WHAT WILL BE INSIDE THE BOOK?

The book will be divided into simple sections.

🌸 Topic 1: MENYA AMABERE YAWE

Know your breasts

This section introduces breast health in simple language and encourages people to understand what is normal for them.

It will use illustrations instead of complicated medical descriptions.

🌸 Topic 2: MENYA IMPINDUKA ZIDASANZWE

Know concerning changes

This section will use clear illustrations to explain examples of breast changes that should be discussed with a qualified healthcare professional.

Possible illustrations can include:

- **A new lump or swelling**
- **Changes in breast shape or size**
- **Skin changes**
- **Nipple changes**
- **Unusual discharge**
- **Other concerning changes**

The book will clearly explain that an illustrated change does not automatically mean cancer.

The purpose is to encourage appropriate professional assessment.

🌸 Topic 3: NTUTINYE KUGISHA INAMA

Don't let fear stop you from seeking help

This section addresses fear and hesitation.

A short story can show a woman who notices a concerning change but is afraid to talk about it.

The message:

> **“Ntukishingikirize ku bwoba cyangwa ku bihuha. Shaka inama y’umukozi w’ubuzima ubifitiye ubumenyi.”**

🌸 Topic 4: IBINYOMA N’UKURI

Myths and facts

This section will challenge common misinformation.

It will use:

❌ IKINYOMA

and

✅ UKURI

The information will be reviewed against reliable health sources before publication.

🌸 Topic 5: NI IKI NAKORA?

What should I do?

This will be one of the most practical sections.

The book will show a simple pathway:

👀 Notice a concerning change

↓

🗣️ Talk to someone you trust

↓

🏥 Seek professional medical advice

↓

👩‍⚕️ Follow the advice of a qualified healthcare professional

This teaches people that the book is not a diagnostic tool.

🌸 Topic 6: PINK FAMILY

Learn together

This section encourages family conversations.

The reader can share what they learned with:

👩 **Mother**
👵 **Grandmother**
👩 **Sister**
👩 **Aunt**
👨 **Father**
👧 **Daughter**
👭 **Friends**

A simple message can appear:

> **“Uyu munsi, sangiza umuntu umwe ibyo wize.”**

“Today, share what you learned with one person.”

This allows one book to reach more than one person.

🌸 Topic 7: AHO WABONA UBUFASHA

Where to seek help

The book will include verified information about appropriate health services and professional sources.

Depending on the final distribution area, this section can contain:

🏥 **Health facilities**
📍 **Locations**
☎️ **Relevant contact information**
ℹ️ **Available services**

This information will be verified and updated before the books are distributed.

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5. HOW WILL THE PROJECT WORK?

The project will follow a simple process:

STEP 1 — RESEARCH

We will work with qualified health professionals and reliable health information sources to identify the information that should be included.

STEP 2 — DESIGN

We will transform complicated information into:

- **Simple Kinyarwanda and other languages.**
- **Pictures**
- **Short explanations like the story someone is telling.**
- **Stories**
- **Questions**
- **Activities**

STEP 3 — PROFESSIONAL REVIEW

Before distribution, the educational content should be reviewed by appropriate healthcare professionals to reduce misinformation and ensure that the book does not encourage self-diagnosis.

STEP 4 — COMMUNITY TESTING

We will test the prototype with different groups.

For example:

👧 **Young people**
👩 **Adults**
👵 **Older people**
📖 **People with different literacy levels**

We will ask:

“Can you understand this picture?”

“What message do you get from this page?”

“Which pages are confusing?”

Then we improve the book.

STEP 5 — PRINTING

After testing and review, we produce the final books.

STEP 6 — DISTRIBUTION

The books are distributed through community gatherings such as Umuganda, youth gatherings, mothers gatherings, and events that brings people together.

STEP 7 — COMMUNITY EDUCATION

Trained Pink Youth volunteers or community partners use the book to facilitate conversations.

STEP 8 — MEASURE IMPACT

We measure how many people were reached and whether they understood the key messages.

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6. HOW WILL THE BOOK REACH EVERYONE?

This is the most important part of the project.

We don't want to say:

“Everyone should come and get the book.”

Instead:

THE BOOK GOES TO THE PEOPLE.

🏘️ 1. COMMUNITY CENTERS

Copies can be placed in appropriate community locations where people regularly gather.

🏥 2. HEALTH FACILITIES

Educational copies can be made available in appropriate health settings, subject to partnership and professional review.

⛪ 3. CHURCHES AND COMMUNITY GROUPS

Community groups can use the book during health-education sessions.

🏫 4. SCHOOLS AND YOUTH GROUPS

Young people can learn from the book and take the knowledge into their families.

👨‍👩‍👧‍👦 5. FAMILY NETWORK

A person who receives the book can share the information with family members.

Therefore:

1 book → 1 family → several people

🚲 6. MOBILE COMMUNITY OUTREACH

Pink Youth volunteers and partners can carry the books to communities rather than requiring everyone to travel.

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7. THE “NO PHONE” PRINCIPLE

One of the strongest features of the Pink Book is:

📵 NO PHONE REQUIRED

The project does not require:

❌ Smartphone
❌ Internet
❌ WhatsApp
❌ Computer
❌ Social media account

A person only needs access to the physical book or a person who can explain it.

This makes the project different from many digital health campaigns.

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8. HOW WILL WE HELP PEOPLE WHO CANNOT READ?

This is where the Picture Book becomes more than an ordinary book.

Each important message will have a strong visual component.

For example:

Instead of:

> **“Pay attention to changes in the appearance of your breast.”**

We show:

👩 → 🩷 → 👀 → ⚠️ → 🏥

A trained educator explains the meaning.

The book therefore becomes a visual communication tool, not simply a reading book.

For the people who live with Blindness disabilty

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9. CHALLENGES WE MAY FACE

Every project has challenges.

Challenge 1: Cost of printing

Producing high-quality, colorful books can be expensive.

Solution:

Start with a prototype and small pilot. Seek partnerships, sponsorships, and responsible printing support before expanding.

Challenge 2: Medical misinformation

Incorrect information could cause fear or false reassurance.

Solution:

Have the content reviewed by qualified healthcare professionals and use reliable health sources.

Challenge 3: Reaching remote communities

Some communities may be difficult to reach.

Solution:

Work through existing community structures and organizations rather than creating an entirely new distribution system.

Challenge 4: People may not understand some pictures

A picture that seems obvious to the designer may not be obvious to everyone.

Solution:

Test → Listen → Improve → Test again.

The community should help us design the book.

Challenge 5: Maintaining accurate information

Health recommendations can change.

Solution:

Include a review date and establish a process for updating future editions.

Challenge 6: People may confuse education with diagnosis

Someone might look at a picture and try to diagnose themselves.

Solution:

Clearly state throughout the book:

> **"This book is for education. It does not diagnose breast cancer. If you have a concerning change, seek advice from a qualified healthcare professional."**

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10. EXPECTED IMPACT ON RWANDAN SOCIETY

The project aims to create impact at several levels.

👩 INDIVIDUAL LEVEL

People can gain simple, understandable breast-health knowledge.

They can become more comfortable discussing breast health and understand appropriate next steps when they notice concerning changes.

👨‍👩‍👧 FAMILY LEVEL

The project encourages families to discuss health openly.

One person learning from the book can share the information with other family members.

🏘️ COMMUNITY LEVEL

Communities gain a reusable educational resource that does not depend on smartphones or internet access.

🇷🇼 NATIONAL LEVEL

If successfully tested and scaled through appropriate partners, the concept could contribute to more inclusive breast-health education across Rwanda.

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11. HOW WILL WE MEASURE SUCCESS?

We should not simply say:

> **“Thousands of people will be reached.”**

We should measure it.

Possible indicators:

📚 **Number of books produced**

👥 **Number of people reached**

🏘️ **Number of communities reached**

👩 **Number of community educators trained**

🧠 **Percentage of participants who correctly understand key messages after education**

❓ **Number of myths correctly identified before and after the session**

📖 **Percentage of participants who say the pictures are understandable**

🗣️ **Number of family conversations generated**

🏥 **Number of people who report understanding where to seek professional advice**

The exact targets should be established after the pilot.

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12. THE PILOT PROJECT

We don't need to immediately try to cover all of Rwanda.

We can begin with a pilot.

Phase 1 — Prototype

Create approximately 20–30 pages.

Phase 2 — Expert review

Healthcare professionals review the content.

Phase 3 — Community testing

Test the book with different groups and literacy levels.

Phase 4 — Improvement

Change confusing pictures, words, or explanations.

Phase 5 — Pilot distribution

Distribute the improved version to selected communities.

Phase 6 — Evaluation

Measure whether people understand and remember the key messages.

Phase 7 — Scale

If the pilot demonstrates value, seek partnerships to expand the project to additional communities across Rwanda.

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13. WHAT MAKES PINK PICTURE BOOK INNOVATIVE?

The innovation is not simply “we created a book.”

The innovation is:

> **We designed breast-health education around the people who are normally hardest to reach.**

A smartphone user can receive digital information.

A person without a smartphone can use the physical book.

A person who can read can read it.

A person who struggles to read can understand the pictures with the help of a trained educator.

A person in a remote community can receive the book through community outreach.

A family can use one book together.

Therefore:

ACCESS SHOULD NOT DEPEND ON TECHNOLOGY OR LITERACY.

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14. LONG-TERM VISION

The Pink Picture Book can become the first part of a larger Pink Education System.

📕 Pink Picture Book

Visual education

🎧 Pink Voice

Audio education

🏘️ Pink Community

Community educators

🎭 Pink Theatre

Drama and storytelling

🎒 Pink Box

Portable education kit

📱 Pink Digital

Digital resources for people who have technology

The principle remains the same:

Different people need different ways to receive the same important health message.

15. FINAL MESSAGE

The Pink Picture Book is built around a simple belief:

> **A person's access to health information should not depend on whether they own a phone, have the internet, can read, or live close to a city.**

We want to create a resource that can sit in a family home, be carried to a village, be used in a community meeting, be explained to someone who cannot read, and help start conversations about breast health.

We are not trying to replace healthcare professionals.

We are trying to build a bridge between health information and the people who may otherwise be left behind.

🌸 **PINK PICTURE BOOK**

“A Book That Speaks Beyond Words.”

”It all starts from everyone knowing what, how, when, why, and where.”

No phone.

No internet.

No complicated medical language.

No one left behind.